

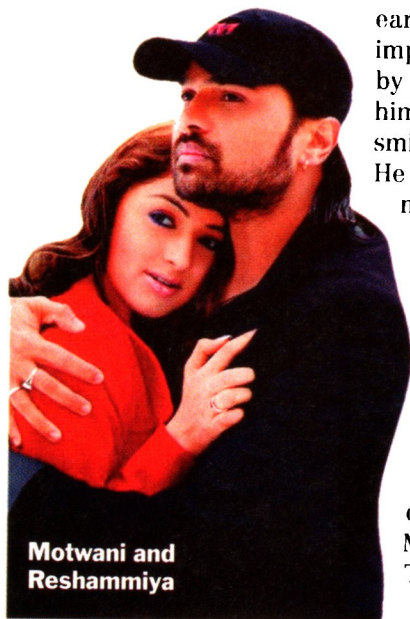
film review

New Narcissus

AAP KA SURROOR

Starring: Himesh Reshammiya, Hansika Motwani
Director: Prashant Chadha

What does Himesh Reshammiya look like without his cap? If you watch this seriously unfunny promotional video waiting for the answer, you have every right to feel like a mug. Because we don't know. We also don't know the answer to all the other



Motwani and Reshammiya

earth-shatteringly important questions raised by HR, as the movie calls him. Why doesn't he smile? Or drink? Or date? He sings the Gayatri mantra, utters *Jai mata di*, salutes India's auto drivers and prefers his women in salwar kameezes—what else can explain his opting for the blobby former child star Hansika Motwani instead of the luscious, can't-keep-my-dress-on Mallika Sherawat? Truly tacky.

Sob Saga

APNE

Starring: Dharmendra, Sunny Deol, Bobby Deol
Director: Anil Sharma

The father, the sons



and everyone else in the movie sob their hearts out. The three-hour weepathon has a wildly improbable plot but when has that ever come in the way of Deol heroics? Bobby Deol, despite baring extraordinary cleavage in the boxing scenes, almost manages to beat the world heavyweight champion;

The Deol father and sons

Sunny actually succeeds. Their father cries and cajoles while romancing the mother of all Punjabi matrons Kirron Kher and uttering fortune cookie homilies: hit life before it hits you back; you can ban me but you can't ban the spirit in me. But is there another 72-year-old who can play an Olympics silver medallist? For those who like *paaji's* punches with a desi *dum* and macho men with marshmallow souls, *Apne* is like a group hug.

Psuedo Sufism

AWARAPAN

Starring: Emraan Hashmi, Mrinalani Sharma
Director: Mohit Suri

Emraan Hashmi as a Sufi soldier who sacrifices his soul for a Pakistani woman whom he doesn't kiss even once? Incredible but true. Shot in warm golden light by Mohit Suri, Hashmi is self-effacingly quiet and quite efficient as a hitman seeking redemption which will come only when he defies the underworld boss who treats him

Hashmi plods along



like a son. The plot is thick with cliches and the direction, in the urge to induce a pseudo-spiritual calm to the movie, is painfully plodding. Add to that dialogues for Sharma, who plays a Pakistani sex slave, that make her sound like an extra in *Pakeezah*, and this becomes little more than a showreel for Hashmi's new hair. The music, by Mustafa Zahid, yet another Pakistani singer whom the Bhatt factory has discovered, is stunning. Shame about the movie. **by Kaverie Bamzai**

music

Classicism Revisited

SIPRA DAS

Chowdhury



SAROD MAESTRO

Biswajit Roy Chowdhury has been conferred the Knight of the Order of Arts & Letters by the French Government. An eclectic but austere classicism sets him apart from other musicians. Excerpts from a conversation with Assistant Editor S. SAHAYA RANJIT:

Q. What does this award mean to you?

A. It makes me humble that I am being recognised for my contribution to popularising classical music.

Q. You learnt from two gurus of different gharans. What's your musical style?

A. I've sourced the best from my gurus, Ustad Amjad Ali Khan and Pandit Mallikarjun Mansur. I just didn't mix and match or reproduce the same music. It is my interpretation of the philosophy of the raga but predominantly, my approach is that of Jaipur Atrauli gharana. I have also played rare ragas—Bhankar, Kukubh Bilawal, Nat-bihag—which had not been played on instruments before.

Q. What is your advice to the younger generation?

A. There is nothing wrong in experimenting with fusion but don't succumb to the demands of the basest market. Discover the treasures of classicism.